

LA.3 Inspection Sequence

Who inspects your house in Louisiana, in what order, and the route the statute gives you when your parish has no counter.

Before you use this document

This is a process reference, not legal advice. Louisiana writes one mandatory construction code for the whole state and then hands enforcement to each parish and municipality, which is why the code your house must meet is the same in Cameron Parish as in Caddo while the office that inspects it, the forms it hands you and the fee it charges are not. Confirm every local item with the office that will actually handle your parcel before you rely on it.

WHO INSPECTS — AND THE SENTENCE WORTH THE PRICE OF THIS KIT

Louisiana requires that code enforcement be done by an inspector **licensed by the state commission**. That inspector might be on your parish's payroll, might work for a regional planning commission, might be a private firm the parish has contracted with — or might be someone **you hire yourself**. That last option is not a workaround. It is written into the enforcement statute, and homeowners claiming the owner-builder exemption are named in it.

The private-inspector route, in the statute's own words

“Licensed contractors, and homeowners exempted from the contractor licensing law pursuant to R.S. 37:2157, may establish agreements with private inspectors to conduct plan reviews, inspections, and enforce the State Uniform Construction Code.”

With one condition attached, also verbatim: “A local jurisdiction shall not accept an inspection report or plan review for the enforcement of the Uniform Construction Code from a private inspector **unless that inspector has a contract to provide inspection services with that jurisdiction ... or has registered with that jurisdiction.**”

So the sequence is: find a Commission-licensed inspector who already works your parish, confirm they are contracted with or registered to that parish, and the parish must then take their reports. In a thinly staffed rural parish this is how an owner-builder keeps a build moving instead of waiting on a schedule nobody is keeping.

La. R.S. 37:3737(A)(1), enacted by Acts 2026, No. 881. If you meet this rule cited as R.S. 40:1730.23, that is the repealed numbering — see the note in LA.2. Some parishes publish their registered private inspectors: Ouachita Parish maintains a roster on its permit-office site, which is the clearest public illustration of how the rule works in practice.

Four ways your house gets inspected in Louisiana

Parish runs its own office	Most populous parishes. A Permits & Inspections, Planning & Development or Public Works division does plan review, issues the permit and inspects.
Consolidated city-parish	One government covers both. East Baton Rouge, Lafayette and Terrebonne are consolidated; Orleans Parish and the City of New Orleans are coterminous, so the City's department is the only authority in the parish.
Contracted out	The parish appoints an outside building official under an agreement the statute expressly authorizes. It may be a regional planning commission, a neighboring government, or a private inspection firm. Bossier, Union, Concordia, St. Martin, Vernon and Rapides all publish arrangements like this.
You bring your own inspector	The route quoted above. Available to an owner-builder anywhere, subject to the inspector being registered with or contracted to your jurisdiction.

STAGE ONE: THE APPROVALS THAT COME BEFORE THE PERMIT

This is the part that catches people who have built in other states. In much of Louisiana the building permit application is effectively a **routing sheet**: other offices sign it before the permit office will look at it, and in some parishes the application form is not even handed out by the permit office. Union Parish's published instructions have the applicant collect the form from the 9-1-1 office, which completes and signs the top portion, then take it to the parish health unit for a second signature, and only then to the Police Jury.

Pre-permit approvals, in the order they usually run

	Approval	Who	Notes
1	911 / E-911 address	The parish 911 district, the sheriff's office, or the permit office itself, depending on parish.	Do this first. It appeared as step one on more parish pages than any other item. One parish warns that the address will not be assigned until your front door is in place, so ask early what their trigger is.
2	Sewage approval	The parish health unit — a Louisiana Department of Health office, not parish government — or a letter from the public sewer utility.	The LHS-47 temporary permit, or written confirmation of public sewer service. Several parishes will not accept an application without it.
3	Driveway / culvert	Parish public works for a parish road; the state highway department for any state or US route.	On a state route the document is an Access Connection Permit and there is a residential version of the form. It asks for culvert diameter, length and material, so have the site laid out before you apply.

Pre-permit approvals, in the order they usually run

	Approval	Who	Notes
4	Flood determination	The parish floodplain manager — in Louisiana usually the same person who signs your building permit.	In a Special Flood Hazard Area expect a proposed elevation certificate before the permit and a final one before the certificate of occupancy.
5	Legal description	Tax assessor or clerk of court.	Several parishes ask for the current parcel listing from the assessor; the health unit wants a plat with a surveyor's seal <i>or</i> a clerk of court "true copy" certification.
6	Utility account	Your electric provider.	Unusual outside Louisiana: some parishes want the electrical provider's account number, or a current utility bill, with the application itself.

Compiled from published requirement lists on the permit pages of Ouachita, Union, Beauregard, Vernon, Grant, Acadia, Ascension, Caddo, St. Helena and St. Martin parishes, read September 2026. Every parish differs in the details — this is the recurring shape, not a universal list. Confirm yours and write it into LA.4.

STAGE TWO: THE BUILDING INSPECTIONS

Louisiana publishes **no statewide inspection schedule** for a one- or two-family dwelling, and there is a precise reason for that which is worth understanding, because it tells you where your schedule actually comes from.

Why there is no state inspection list — and where yours comes from

Louisiana adopts the IRC **"not including Part I-Administrative."** Part I is IRC Chapter 1, and IRC Chapter 1 is where **R109, Inspections** lives, along with permits, fees and construction documents. So the chapter that would have given Louisiana a required-inspection list is the one chapter the state deliberately left out — and the predecessor statute was explicit that the agency could not add it back.

Your inspection schedule therefore comes from your parish or town, under its own administrative ordinance. **Ask for the inspection card or schedule when the permit issues** and put it beside the log at the back of this document. Do not assume the sequence you used in another state.

Rather than invent a list, here is one parish's *published* set of required inspections, which is representative of what a Louisiana owner-builder should expect to call in.

Ouachita Parish's published required inspections

“plumbing rough-in / foundation / open wall / electrical service connection / final for certificate of occupancy.” Read that order carefully — the **plumbing rough-in comes first**, because on a slab the drain lines are in the ground before the foundation is poured. That is the inspection an owner-builder is most likely to pour concrete over.

Whatever your jurisdiction schedules, the state adds a handful of hard requirements on top. These four are worth knowing by name.

- **Your inspector has to physically show up.** R.S. 37:3737(H) requires that a properly-licensed inspector conduct all inspections and **“be present on site for all inspections other than roofing inspections, reinspections where that inspector previously visited the site, and emergency utility reconnection inspections.”** Geotagged photographs or video may be accepted for those three exceptions and nothing else. If someone proposes to inspect your framing from a phone, that is not what the statute allows.
- **The roof is separately mandated.** R.S. 37:3737(I)(2) requires the jurisdiction to permit and inspect one- and two-family dwellings “for roof construction and reroofing in compliance with the International Residential Code Chapters 8 and 9 requirements.” This one is not optional anywhere in the state.
- **The energy tests need certified testers.** The adopted energy provisions require blower-door testing performed by individuals certified by a nationally recognized organization, and duct-leakage testing likewise, with the building official directed to accept written reports from those certified individuals. Book them; there is no visual alternative.
- **The insulation certificate is a physical artifact.** A Louisiana insulation certificate posted in a utility area is a code requirement, and it is the sort of thing a final inspector looks for and an owner-builder forgets.

Two more rules are about not covering work up, and they are the ones that cost money when missed.

- **Septic: nothing may be covered before the sanitarian verifies it.** The health department's own applicant form says the system “must be inspected by an Office of Public Health sanitarian before any portion of the system is covered,” and asks for **24 hours** notice ahead of expected completion. Backfilling early means digging it up.
- **Third-party reports have to reach the parish.** If you are using a private or contracted inspector, the parish still needs the documentation in its file. Ouachita states it plainly: applicants using third-party inspectors “must make sure permit office receives documentation of inspections.” Nobody will chase it for you.

Remember the rule from LA.2 while you build: your inspector works from **the codes in effect when you applied**, not the codes current on the day of the inspection. If a code cycle turns over mid-build, that sentence is your protection — bring your dated application if it is ever questioned.

STAGE THREE: CLOSING OUT

The closing sequence

Final inspections	Building, electrical, plumbing, mechanical — plus the final elevation certificate if you are in a Special Flood Hazard Area.
Septic final approval	The sanitarian's final verification, with the installer present and the state identification tag turned in to the local health unit. Until that is done, the health office will not approve the site for utilities.
Certificate of occupancy	Issued by the permitting authority. Notify them that the project is complete before anyone occupies the building — at least one parish states that requirement explicitly.
The recording step most owners miss	On a new-construction mortgage the lender files the certificate of occupancy in the parish conveyance records , and the statute puts the duty on you to hand the lender a copy. Do not treat the CO as the last piece of paper you will ever need.
Utility release	Several parishes tie permanent power to the final inspection and, on a septic site, to the health unit's sign-off. Line the two up or you will be finished and dark.

Certificate of occupancy recording: R.S. 37:3737(E)(1)–(2) — the lender files the CO in the conveyance records and “the owner of the new residential construction shall provide the lender a copy of the certificate of occupancy.” Septic final approval and utility release: LDH form SF-10ST and the Office of Public Health applicant packet. Occupancy notice: Ouachita Parish Police Jury permit office.

INSPECTION LOG

Record every inspection as it happens, including the inspector's license number. In a state where your inspector may be a private firm rather than a parish employee, that number is what ties the report to a person the Commission licenses.

Inspections on this project

Inspection	Date called	Date done	Inspector / license no.	Result
Septic — site survey by sanitarian				
Plumbing rough-in / under-slab				
Foundation				
Septic — final verification (before cover)				
Framing / open wall				

Inspections on this project

Inspection	Date called	Date done	Inspector / license no.	Result
Electrical rough-in				
Mechanical rough-in				
Insulation				
Electrical service connection				
Final elevation certificate (flood zone)				
Final electrical				
Final plumbing				
Final mechanical				
Final building				
Certificate of occupancy issued				

The rows above are a working sequence assembled from published parish requirements and the health department's septic process. **They are not a statewide schedule** — Louisiana does not publish one for dwellings. Cross out what your jurisdiction does not call for, and write in what it adds.

Sources — every Louisiana claim in this document (verified September 2026)

What this document states	Authority
Enforcement must be by a Commission-licensed inspector	R.S. 37:3737(A)(1)
Homeowners exempt under R.S. 37:2157 may hire private inspectors	R.S. 37:3737(A)(1)
A private inspector must be contracted with or registered to the jurisdiction	R.S. 37:3737(A)(1)
A parish may contract enforcement to another entity or a licensed private inspector	R.S. 37:3740
Inspections use the codes in force on the original application date	R.S. 37:3734

Sources — every Louisiana claim in this document (verified September 2026)

What this document states	Authority
No state inspection schedule: IRC Part I-Administrative, which contains R109, is not adopted	R.S. 37:3733(A)(3)
Inspector must be present on site, with three named exceptions	R.S. 37:3737(H)
Roof construction and reroofing must be permitted and inspected	R.S. 37:3737(I)(2)
Blower-door and duct-leakage testing by certified individuals; insulation certificate posted	LA amendments to 2021 IECC, LAC 17:I.117
Lender records the certificate of occupancy; owner supplies the copy	R.S. 37:3737(E)(1)-(2)
Nothing covered before the sanitarian verifies; 24 hours notice	LDH form SF-10ST; OPH applicant packet
Utilities not approved until final verification and tag returned	OPH applicant packet
Representative required-inspection list and third-party documentation rule	Ouachita Parish Police Jury permit office
Pre-permit routing through the 911 office and parish health unit	Union Parish Police Jury, building permit instructions
Residential access connection permit on a state route	Louisiana DOTD, Access Connection Permit Certificate

Everything cited here is free to read. A **R.S.** citation is a Louisiana Revised Statute — search the number at **legis.la.gov** under Louisiana Laws. A **LAC** citation is the Louisiana Administrative Code, published as free PDFs by the Office of the State Register at **doa.la.gov**. Rules newer than the last codified printing appear only in the Louisiana Register at the same site, so check there before relying on a date. Read September 2026.